HOW TO APPLY FOR A PERMIT

Applying for a short-term rental permit is easy.

You can apply online
www.cityofpasadena.net/shorttermrentals

In addition to completion of the online form, the following is required for online application submission:

1. Property Inspection Self-Certification
2. Copy of Neighborhood Notice and addresses of the properties notified
3. Proof of primary residency at the property
4. Photographs of the property
5. Payment of the permit application fee
6. Short-term Rental Affidavit (notarized)

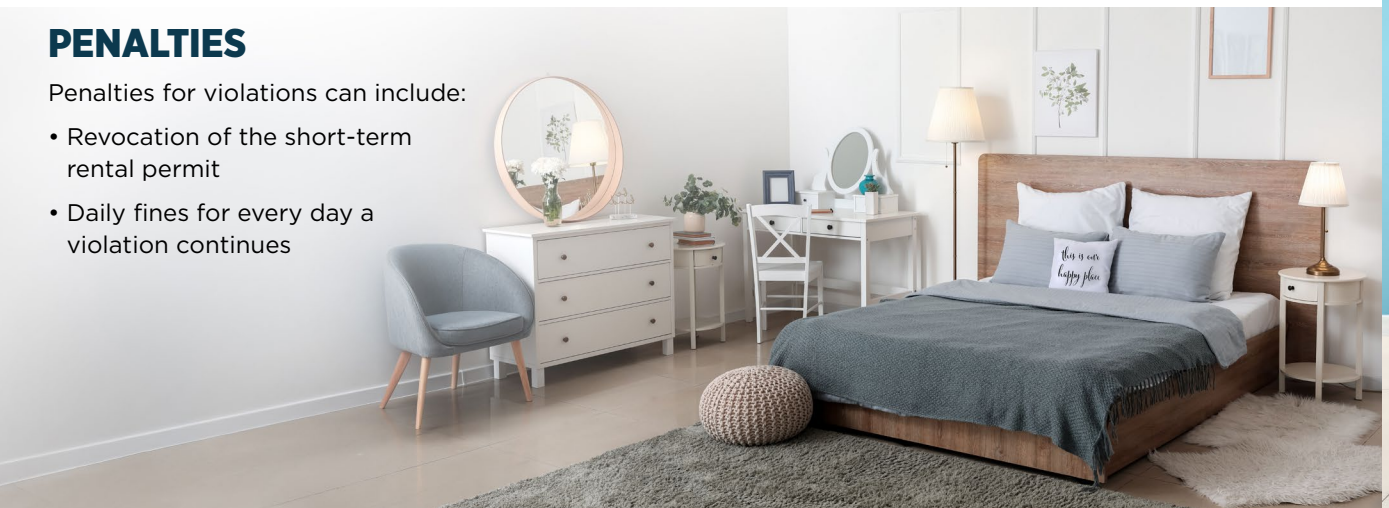
ENFORCEMENT

Short-term rentals are subject to compliance with the operating standards in PMC Section 17.50.296 for Short-Term Rental Regulations, Chapter 9.36 for Noise Restrictions and Chapter 8.64 for Litter Control. Three (3) violations against the same property being used for short-term rental will result in the revocation of the permit. Violations shall also be subject to administrative fines and penalties pursuant to PMC Sections 1.25.160 and 1.25.170.

PENALTIES

Penalties for violations can include:

- Revocation of the short-term rental permit
- Daily fines for every day a violation continues



QUESTIONS?

For questions regarding the regulations or permitting process, call the Planner of the Day at **(626)744-6777**

For questions regarding Transient Occupancy Tax, call **(626)744-4538**
email **strquestions@cityofpasadena.net**

For questions regarding the permit or tax portals, email **strpermits@cityofpasadena.net**

City of Pasadena
Planning & Community Development Department
175 N. Garfield Avenue
www.cityofpasadena.net/shorttermrentals

AUGUST 2026

PASADENA
PLANNING & COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT

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Short-Term Rentals

*This brochure does not include all Short-Term Rental regulations. Copies of the Short-Term Rental ordinance are available at the City Clerk's Office and at **www.cityofpasadena.net/shorttermrentals**



WHAT IS A SHORT-TERM RENTAL?

A short-term rental is a dwelling unit which is shared, in whole or in part, for transient occupancy for periods of up to 30 consecutive days as a way of generating rental income.

Ordinance No. 7137 allows hosted and unhosted short-term rentals, subject to regulations. This brochure summarizes the City's short-term rental regulations and permit requirements.

TYPES OF SHORT-TERM RENTAL PERMITS

Short-term rental permits will be issued only for properties which are the 'primary residence' of the host. A 'primary residence' is defined as the host's permanent residence where he or she resides for a minimum of 9 months per year.

- Permit Type 1: A 'hosted' stay is where the host remains on-site throughout the guest's stay (except during daytime and or work hours). A common example of this is where a host short-term rents a bedroom(s) in their home.
- Permit Type 2: An 'unhosted' stay is where the host is off-site during a guest's stay. A common example is where the host rents their primary residence while they are out of town. Unhosted stays are limited to 90 days per year.



FAQS

I own a property in Pasadena but I don't live there. Can I short-term rent that property?

No, a dwelling can only be short-term rented if it is the host's primary residence. If the host does not reside at the property for 9 or more months out of the year, then it can only be rented for stays of 31 or more days at a time.

Who can obtain a short-term rental permit?

Only the primary resident of the unit may obtain a short term rental permit. This may be the property owner or, with the owner's approval, a tenant.

What can be short-term rented?

Single bedrooms or entire units including condos, townhomes, and apartments may be used as short term rentals. In owner occupied multi unit properties (such as duplexes or triplexes), the owner may rent their primary residence plus one additional unit.

What cannot be short-term rented?

Accessory dwelling units (ADUs) permitted on or after January 1, 2017, non permitted structures, vacation homes, commercial units, and any non habitable structures are not eligible for short-term rental use.

Is there a limit to the number of guests allowed?

Yes. Occupancy is limited to 2 guests per bedroom plus 2 additional guests. For example, a two bedroom unit may host up to 6 guests.

Is there a limit on how often I can short term rent my home?

Hosted stays have no limit. Unhosted stays are limited to 90 days per year.

Do I need to obtain a permit?

Yes. A Short-Term Rental permit is required and must be renewed annually. Apply online at **www.cityofpasadena.net/shorttermrentals.**

Are there permit fees or taxes?

Yes. Permit holders must pay an annual permit renewal fee and remit Transient Occupancy Tax (TOT) and the Tourism Business Improvement District (TBID) assessment quarterly. Remittance can be made online at **www.cityofpasadena.net/shorttermrentals.**

Why does my short term rental need an inspection?

An inspection is required before the permit is issued to confirm basic fire and life safety compliance. Self-certification or third party inspections may be allowed, except if the rental is an accessory structure.

Do I need to provide parking for guests?

Yes. Parking for guests must be *provided on the property.* Street parking for guests is not allowed.

I own a condominium but my CC&Rs prohibit short term rentals. Can I rent it anyway?

No. Applicants must comply with all applicable HOA and CC&R rules. A city permit does not override HOA or CC&R restrictions.

Are there any requirements for how the property is listed on a platform?

Yes. The City issued Short-Term Rental permit number must be included in all listings and advertisements.

Do I need to notify my neighbors?

Yes. A completed Neighborhood Notice must be delivered or mailed to all directly abutting property owners. A copy of the notice and a list of notified addresses must be submitted with the permit application.

Are commercial events or gatherings allowed?

No. Commercial events, parties, or group gatherings including weddings, banquets, and corporate events are prohibited.